

AN UNOFFICIAL FAN SUPPLEMENT FOR

HARPOON

Captain's Edition

FIRST ISLAND CHAIN

US Navy vs. PLA Navy • a 2026 scenario

Original game design by Larry Bond, developed by Frank Chadwick (Game Designers' Workshop, 1990).

Harpoon Captain's Edition is available free at admiraltytrilogy.com/ce.php.

This supplement replaces the North Atlantic / NATO-vs-Soviet setting with a modern US Navy vs. PLA Navy order of battle, map, and scenario set. It uses the same core rules, dice tables, and turn sequence as the original *Captain's Rules* booklet — nothing about the underlying mechanics has changed.

How to Use This Supplement

This booklet is designed to sit alongside your copy of *Harpoon Captain's Edition*. You'll still need:

- The original **Captain's Rules** booklet (movement, detection, missile/gun combat, submarines, aircraft — all rules are unchanged; the Game Reference Chart is reprinted on the next page for convenience).
- Four six-sided dice.
- A cup or bowl for movement chits (or use any small tokens/coins marked 1–14 per side).

What's new in this supplement:

- A new hex map covering the **First Island Chain** — the Ryukyus, Taiwan, the Bashi Channel, and Luzon (1 hex = 60 nautical miles, same scale as the original GIUK-gap map).
- New data cards for 22 US Navy and 22 PLA Navy ships, submarines, and aircraft, plus generic merchant/tanker/ amphibious units and dummy cards for both sides.
- New Base Charts for Kadena, Taipei/Zuoying, and Subic Bay (US/allied) and Ningbo-Zhoushan, Xiamen, and Yulin/Sanya (PLA Navy), plus carrier air wing reference boxes.
- A new Roster Sheet sized to the new order of battle.
- Ten introductory scenarios (play them in order the first time — each introduces a new rule, exactly like the original game's scenario progression) plus the full Advanced/mission-purchase scenario system, reskinned with new mission descriptions for both sides.
- A "Tools of Modern Naval Warfare" section explaining what each new card represents and why.

A note on scope. This is a hobbyist tabletop wargame supplement, not a predictive or analytical document. The First Island Chain setting and PLAN-vs-USN framing are common territory for open, unclassified wargaming and commentary (think tanks, war colleges, and other published tabletop designs have used the same premise for years); nothing here is drawn from classified sources, and no scenario should be read as a forecast. Unit statistics are abstracted for playability — exactly as the original *Captain's Edition* abstracted 1990 NATO and Soviet platforms — and are built from open-source reporting current as of mid-2026, which is necessarily incomplete for several of the newest platforms on both sides (e.g. J-35, Type 076, Constellation-class).

Compressed Rules

This section compresses the full Captain's Rules booklet (movement, combat, detection, submarines, and aircraft) into a few pages so this supplement can be played on its own. Nothing here changes the original mechanics — only ship/aircraft names and nation labels have been swapped for US Navy / PLA Navy. If anything below is unclear, the full original booklet (identical dice tables and procedures) is free at admiraltytrilogy.com/ce.php.

1. Sequence of Play

Each turn = 8 hours (3 turns/day: AM, PM, Night). Draw one task-force or patrol-aircraft movement chit at random from the cup; that unit declares its speed (up to its printed maximum) and moves one hex at a time, may attack or be attacked in each hex it enters, then the next chit is drawn. When the cup is empty, the turn ends and chits are reshuffled. Night turns: no visual search.

2. Surface Ships

Task Forces

Ships are grouped face-down into task forces before play; one task-force counter and movement chit represents the whole group. Forces may split (before movement chits are drawn) or combine (when one force moves into another's hex and declares it is joining). A task force may not move faster than its slowest ship, but may always move at 1 hex/turn regardless of speed.

Combat

Entering an enemy-occupied hex allows an attack (only against detected units) or being attacked; the moving player chooses to attack or not, the non-moving player then decides whether to counterattack.

Ship Damage

Each ship has a Hull rating = number of hull boxes. Mark one box per hit. At 1/2 hull remaining: speed -1 hex, lose all SSMs, lose air search radar (carriers can't launch aircraft). At 2/3 lost: speed = 1, all weapons except half Guns (round up) lost, lose sonar/ESM (surface search radar only). At 0 boxes: sunk.

Surface-to-Surface Missiles (SSM)

Short-range SSM = 1-hex range; long-range SSM = 3-hex range. Attack strength may be split across any number of targets in range. Ammunition is limited — mark one Roster Sheet box per missile factor fired; once exhausted, no more SSM fire until resupplied at a friendly base.

Missile Attack Procedure

1. Long-range SAM fires first (defender's ships with LR-SAM roll dice = LR-SAM value vs. the Missile Combat Table SAM column; hits reduce the attacking missile raid's strength, defender's choice which factors are removed).
2. Short-range SAM fires next (each ship may only defend itself or the ship it is paired with).
3. Point Defense fires last (each ship defends only itself).
4. Any missile factors that survive all three layers hit the target ship as hull hits (roll dice = surviving factors, using the Missile Combat Table SSM column).

Ships defend in pairs: the "screened" ship is protected by the "screening" ship's SAM/PD, but only the directly attacked ship (or its pair-mate) can be targeted — see **Rollback**, below.

Naval Gunfire

Requires being in the same hex as the enemy (faster force may choose to engage or evade). Ships fire in pairs, one "firing ship" per pair, strongest gun factor first. Roll dice = Gun factor vs. Gun Combat Table; subtract 1 from the die roll if firing at a screened ship. After all guns fire, either side may break off (automatic if both agree, or if the faster force chooses; if forces are equal speed, contest is a die roll of 1-3 for the attacker to force a continued engagement).

Rollback

An attacker may deliberately split fire across a pair (e.g. hitting both the escort and the ship it's protecting) to force the defender to choose between defending itself or its charge — the core tactical decision in both missile and gun combat.

3. Detection

A task force cannot be attacked until detected. Detection methods:

- **Surface Search Radar** (range 1 hex): auto-detects all ships in the same hex when radiating (shown by the red side of the movement chit).
- **ESM**: passively detects an enemy's radar emissions. If a task force moves adjacent to (or is approached by) a radiating enemy force, roll 1 die: 1-5 detects.
- **Visual Search** (day only): entering a hex with enemy ships, roll 1 die: 1-2 detects. May keep rolling each remaining movement point until success, contact is lost, or the hex is left.
- **Sonar**: roll $\leq$ effective sonar value (a roll of 6 always fails). Effective sonar = best sonar-equipped ship's SON value, modified: +1 (multiple sonar ships searching), -2 (1-hex range), -3 (2-hex range), -Speed (searching TF's own speed), +Speed (target TF's speed), +1 (target previously detected by any means).

Dummy Units

Each side has dummy cards representing no real unit (US Navy: 3; PLAN: 5 — reflecting the PLAN's home-field sensor and basing density in this theater). A successful visual/radar search of a dummy-only hex only reveals "no surface ships present" (it could still be a submarine). Sonar detection of a dummy removes it from play. Dummies may be freely shuffled between task forces; reveal to your opponent when doing so, to prove it's a dummy being moved.

4. Submarines

Submarines form their own task forces (never mixed with surface ships), move exactly like surface task forces, but pay only 1 movement point to enter an ice/reef-restricted hex. Subs may be detected only by sonar or ESM — never by radar or visual search directly (a successful visual/SSR search of a sub-only hex just reveals "no surface ships present").

Torpedo Attacks

When a sub successfully moves into a detected enemy formation's hex, it may fire torpedoes at any one ship in the screen (or, if it attacked a screened ship instead, at that ship). Roll dice = Torps value vs. Torpedo Attack Table. A sub's SSM (if any) may also be fired at surface ships using the normal SSM rules — never at other submarines, and never while under an ice shelf.

ASW Counterattack

Any ship or aircraft in the same hex with ASW > 0 that is allowed to see the attacking sub may counterattack with its ASW rating vs. the ASW Attack Table. Only ships that were themselves attacked (or are screening a ship that was) may counterattack.

5. Patrol Aircraft

Represented by one physical model + movement chit per type (not per airframe) — one aircraft is always notionally aloft while others refuel/rest. May move to any hex within radius of a friendly base/carrier each turn, using ASR/SSR/sonar exactly like a ship of that class. May attack subs (ASW) or ships (ASM) if so armed, once per turn. Detected via ASR range, or ESM/visual/sonar search as normal. A hit is resolved on the Aircraft Damage Table: 1 = no effect, 2-3 = abort (returns to base), 4-6 = shot down.

6. Tactical Aircraft

Flown in flights of up to 4 aircraft, based ashore or aboard a carrier (carrier deck-space limits shown on the Base Chart). Each flight may fly (and attack) once per turn, at any range up to its Radius, then returns to base. Tactical aircraft may only attack targets already detected by a friendly task force or patrol aircraft (unless the scenario says otherwise).

ASM & Bomb Attacks

Air-to-surface missiles work exactly like ship SSMs (short/long range, defended the same way). Bomb attacks require being adjacent to the target; defended by long-range SAM, then short-range SAM (fired at the aircraft, not the weapon), then the bomb attack itself resolves — point defense guns do *not* fire on bombers. Multiply the bomb factor by the number of surviving aircraft in the flight for total dice rolled.

Air-to-Air Combat

Only fighters (aircraft with an ATA value) may engage other aircraft or incoming missiles. Roll 1 die per engaged fighter, add its ATA value, subtract the target's Def value, consult the Air-to-Air Combat Table. Missiles have a Def of 0. **CAP** (combat air patrol) flies over a base/task force all turn and may intercept anything passing within its radar range. **DLI** (deck-launched interceptors) launch only when the base/force they defend is attacked. **Escorts** fly with a strike package and absorb the attention of enemy CAP/DLI before the strike aircraft are engaged.

Roll	Result
≤2	Miss
3-7	Hit
8+	2× Hit

Captain's Edition Supplement Map • 1 hex = 60 nautical miles

HARPOON — FIRST ISLAND CHAIN



The Tools of Modern Naval Warfare

The following pages summarize, in plain language, the real-world platforms behind each new data card — why they matter, what makes them dangerous, and roughly how expensive they are to field. Ranges, missile counts, and sensor performance are drawn from open-source reporting currently available (2025–2026); several PLAN systems in particular are not officially disclosed and are best-available estimates. As with the original *Captain's Edition*, all game statistics are a deliberate abstraction for playability, not an intelligence assessment.

US Naval Combatants

CVN Gerald R. Ford — Lead ship of the newest US carrier class. Dual Band Radar and an all-electric design give it the fleet's best air-search picture; the ship carries no area-defense missiles of its own and depends entirely on its air wing and escorts for protection. *[High-cost (2× hull in asset points)]*

CVN Nimitz — The proven workhorse carrier, still the backbone of forward-deployed US carrier strike groups even as Ford-class ships enter service. Same self-defense doctrine as Ford: escorts and aircraft do the shooting. *[High-cost (2× hull in asset points)]*

CG Ticonderoga — The Navy's original Aegis cruiser and its largest missile magazine (122 VLS cells). A dwindling, high-value class being retired through the late 2020s — the few that remain are prized area-air-defense escorts, often assigned as strike group flagships. *[High-cost (2× hull in asset points)]*

DDG Arleigh Burke Flt IIA — The most numerous major surface combatant in the fleet. 96-cell Aegis VLS, SPY-1D radar, two ASW helicopters. The standard escort and multi-mission workhorse of every US carrier and amphibious group. *[High-cost (2× hull in asset points)]*

DDG Arleigh Burke Flt III — Same hull and 96-cell VLS as Flight IIA, but built around the SPY-6(V)1 AMDR radar — roughly double the detection range and far greater simultaneous-track capacity, enough power growth to fight ballistic missiles, cruise missiles, and small surface contacts at once. *[High-cost (2× hull in asset points)]*

FFG Constellation — A FREMM-derived multi-mission frigate carrying 16 Naval Strike Missiles and a 32-cell VLS. The program was cut back in late 2025 to just two hulls — in a 2026 scenario, treat this ship as rare and still working up, not a fleet-wide type. *[Standard cost (= hull in asset points)]*

LCS Independence LCS — A fast, lightly built trimaran fitted with Naval Strike Missiles. Useful as an inexpensive picket or strike-and-scout unit, but it cannot trade blows with a peer combatant and has only point-defense self-protection. *[Low-cost (hull −1 in asset points)]*

SSN Los Angeles (688i) — The oldest US fast-attack design still in service, the Improved (688i) boats add a 12-tube vertical launch system for Tomahawk. Being steadily retired as Virginia-class boats replace them hull-for-hull. *[Standard cost (= hull in asset points)]*

SSN Virginia (Blk III/IV) — The Navy's premier multi-mission attack submarine — quieter and better sensed than Los Angeles, with the same 12-tube Tomahawk fit. The fleet's volume SSN. *[Standard cost (= hull in asset points)]*

SSN Virginia (Blk V, VPM) — An 84-foot hull stretch (the Virginia Payload Module) adds four large-diameter tubes, each holding seven more Tomahawks — over three times the missile capacity of a standard Virginia. Still rare in the fleet in 2026. *[High-cost (2× hull in asset points)]*

SSN Seawolf — Only three of these boats were built (Seawolf, Connecticut, Jimmy Carter). Eight large-diameter torpedo tubes and the deepest weapons room of any US attack submarine make it the quietest, hardest-hitting SSN in the fleet. *[High-cost (2× hull in asset points)]*

SSGN Ohio SSGN — Four former ballistic-missile submarines converted to carry up to 154 Tomahawks apiece in modified missile tubes — the single largest missile magazine afloat. The class is aging out; treat it as a scarce, capital-scale strike asset. *[High-cost (2× hull in asset points)]*

LHA America-class LHA — No well deck — built instead as a de facto light strike carrier ("Lightning Carrier") for up to 20 F-35Bs. Amphibious flagship and, in a pinch, a second flight deck for the fight. *[High-cost (2× hull in asset points)]*

LPD San Antonio LPD — Troop and vehicle lift for a Marine landing force, with a well deck for landing craft and a hangar for one CH-53 or MV-22. Lightly armed — needs an escort. *[Standard cost (= hull in asset points)]*

AO Fleet Oiler (USN) — Underway replenishment ship — fuel and stores for the fleet. Unarmed; the tyranny-of-distance problem of any Western Pacific campaign runs through ships like this one. *[Low-cost (hull −1 in asset points)]*

US Naval Aircraft

Patrol E-2D Advanced Hawkeye — AN/APY-9 radar extends a carrier group's air picture roughly 300 nm — the single most valuable sensor node in the strike group. *[Standard cost (= hull in asset points)]*

Patrol P-8A Poseidon — Land-based, long-range ASW/surface-search patrol jet operating out of Kadena, Guam, or allied fields. Carries Harpoon and up to 129 sonobuoys. *[Standard cost (= hull in asset points)]*

Patrol MQ-4C Triton — Unarmed, 24+ hour-endurance unmanned wide-area maritime surveillance aircraft. Pure sensor platform — cues P-8A and strike aircraft onto targets. *[Standard cost (= hull in asset points)]*

TAC F/A-18E/F Super Hornet — The carrier air wing's primary strike fighter — AESA radar, up to nine air-to-air missiles, and LRASM/Harpoon for anti-ship work. *[Standard cost (= hull in asset points)]*

TAC F-35C Lightning II — Stealth carrier fighter with the longest legs of any F-35 variant, a 360° IR sensor, and a full electronic-warfare suite. Hardest US aircraft to detect or defend against. *[High-cost (2× hull in asset points)]*

TAC EA-18G Growler — Electronic-attack Super Hornet variant carrying ALQ-99 jamming pods and AGM-88 anti-radiation missiles. Special rule: while escorting a strike package, reduce the defending task force's ASR and SSR by 1 (minimum 0) for that attack. *[Standard cost (= hull in asset points)]*

TAC B-1B Lancer — Land-based heavy bomber carrying up to 24 LRASM across three internal bays — a single flight can mount a saturation anti-ship raid at ranges no carrier air wing can match. *[High-cost (2× hull in asset points)]*

PLA Navy Combatants

CV Fujian (Type 003) — China's first catapult carrier, commissioned November 2025 and still working up toward full operational capability. Embarks J-35 stealth fighters, J-15T multirole fighters, and the KJ-600 — the PLAN's first fixed-wing carrier AEW aircraft. *[High-cost (2× hull in asset points)]*

CV Shandong (Type 002) — Ski-jump (STOBAR) carrier, China's first domestically built flattop. No fixed-wing AEW — relies on Z-18 AEW helicopters. Launch-weight limits reduce fuel/weapons load compared to a catapult ship. *[High-cost (2× hull in asset points)]*

CV Liaoning (Type 001) — The rebuilt ex-Varyag hull — oldest and least capable of China's three active carriers, now largely a training and second-line asset. *[Standard cost (= hull in asset points)]*

CG Type 055 (Renhai) — 112-cell VLS — the largest missile magazine on any surface combatant in service anywhere. Type 346B AESA radar, a 130mm gun, and full ASW suite make this the PLAN's flagship escort and the most dangerous individual surface unit in the theater. *[High-cost (2× hull in asset points)]*

DDG Type 052D/DL — 64-cell VLS, Type 346A radar, YJ-18 anti-ship missiles with a terminal supersonic sprint. The PLAN's most numerous major combatant — its rough equivalent of the Arleigh Burke. *[Standard cost (= hull in asset points)]*

FFG Type 054A — PLAN's numerous general-purpose frigate — 32-cell HHQ-16 SAM, 8 YJ-83 anti-ship missiles. Adequate but unspectacular sensors; the class backbone of escort duty since the 2010s. *[Standard cost (= hull in asset points)]*

FFG Type 054B — First hull commissioned January 2025. Bigger hull, a new 100mm gun, and improved sensors/hangar (sized for the Z-20F). Still building up in numbers through 2026. *[Standard cost (= hull in asset points)]*

FS Type 056A (Jiangdao) — Cheap, mass-produced littoral corvette (~50 hulls built) with only point-defense SAM and no aviation hangar. Numerous but weak against air threats — a good screen/picket unit, not a peer combatant. *[Low-cost (hull -1 in asset points)]*

SSN Type 093B — The first PLAN attack submarine with a vertical launch system, reportedly carrying YJ-18 and land-attack cruise missiles. Pump-jet propulsion makes it noticeably quieter than earlier Shang boats — the PLAN's most serious current underwater threat to a carrier group. *[High-cost (2× hull in asset points)]*

SSN Type 093/093A — Earlier-generation nuclear attack boats, no vertical launch system — anti-ship missiles must be fired from the torpedo tubes. Noisier than 093B but still a capable ambush predator. *[Standard cost (= hull in asset points)]*

SSK Type 039A/B — Stirling-cycle air-independent propulsion lets this diesel-electric boat run silent on battery/AIP for days without surfacing. Cheap, quiet, and well suited to ambushing chokepoints like the Bashi Channel — poor sustained transit speed is its main limitation. *[Low-cost (hull -1 in asset points)]*

LHD Type 075 (Yushen) — China's largest amphibious assault ship — helicopter carrier with a floodable well deck for landing craft and armor. Four hulls now in service; the marine landing force flagship. *[High-cost (2× hull in asset points)]*

LHD Type 076 (drone carrier) — A hybrid amphibious ship with an electromagnetic catapult for launching fixed-wing strike/ISR drones rather than manned fighters. Still in sea trials in 2026 — treat as new and not yet combat-ready. *[High-cost (2× hull in asset points)]*

LPD Type 071 (Yuzhao) — Troop/vehicle amphibious transport dock with a well deck for air-cushion landing craft. Less aviation capacity than Type 075; needs an escort. *[Standard cost (= hull in asset points)]*

AOE Type 901 Fuyu AOE — The only PLAN replenishment ship fast enough to keep pace with a carrier task group indefinitely — five resupply gantries allow simultaneous refueling/rearming of multiple ships underway. *[Standard cost (= hull in asset points)]*

AO Type 903A Oiler — Standard PLAN fleet oiler, the backbone of routine underway replenishment for surface task groups operating away from a home port. *[Low-cost (hull -1 in asset points)]*

PLA Naval Aviation

Patrol KJ-500/600 AEW — KJ-500 is the larger, longer-ranged land-based AEW aircraft; KJ-600 is the smaller carrier-based variant now flying from Fujian. Use one card for either, per scenario notes. *[Standard cost (= hull in asset points)]*

Patrol Y-9 GX6 ASW — PLAN Aviation's primary land-based ASW/maritime patrol aircraft — nose radar, tail MAD boom, sonobuoys, and lightweight torpedoes. Shorter-legged than the P-8A. *[Standard cost (= hull in asset points)]*

TAC J-15 / J-15T — PLAN's standard carrier-based multirole fighter. J-15T is the catapult-capable version flying from Fujian; PL-15 gives it a genuine BVR reach. *[Standard cost (= hull in asset points)]*

TAC J-35 — China's new stealth carrier fighter, now in serial production and flying from Fujian. Still rare fleet-wide in 2026 — treat as scarce and high-value. *[High-cost (2× hull in asset points)]*

TAC J-16 — Land-based multirole strike fighter also flown by PLAN Aviation for maritime strike escort and stand-off anti-ship missions from mainland/Hainan airfields. *[Standard cost (= hull in asset points)]*

TAC H-6J / H-6N — Land-based maritime strike bomber — up to seven YJ-12 supersonic anti-ship missiles (H-6J), or an air-launched anti-ship ballistic missile on the H-6N. China's primary "carrier-killer" stand-off strike axis. *[Standard cost (= hull in asset points)]*

Game Reference Chart (unchanged from Captain's Rules)

Combat Chart

Die Roll	SAM	PD	Bombs & SSM	Guns	Torps	ASW
1	M	M	M	M	M	M
2	M	H	M	M	M	M
3	M	H	H	M	M	M
4	H	H	H	H	M	M
5	H	H	H	H	H	H
6	2H	2H	2H	H	2H	H

Sonar Detection

Roll sonar value or less to detect. A roll of 6 always fails. Modify sonar value as follows:

Factor	Modifier
Multiple ships searching	+1
One-hex range	-2
Two-hex range	-3
Searching task force	-Speed
Target task force	+Speed
Target previously detected by any means	+1

Air-to-Air Combat

Die Roll	Result
2 or less	M
3-7	H
8 or more	2H

Aircraft Damage

Die Roll	Result
1	No effect
2-3	Abort
4-6	Shot down

Surface Search

	Visual	ESM
Detects on	1-2	1-5

EA-18G Growler special rule (new, optional): while escorting a strike package, an EA-18G flight reduces the defending task force's ASR and SSR by 1 (minimum 0) for that attack only.

Designer's Notes & Sources

Larry Bond closed the original *Captain's Rules* booklet by writing: "We hope to provide new units, new maps, and more scenarios in future supplements." This booklet is exactly that idea, thirty-six years later and pointed at a different ocean.

Every stat card in this supplement was built the same way the original designers built theirs: start from the real platform's rough size, sensors, and weapons load, then scale it against the other cards already on the table so the relative rankings feel right — a Type 055 should feel like the biggest gun in the room because it is one, a Type 056A corvette should feel outmatched because it is one. Treat every number here as a game abstraction tuned for a fun, roughly-balanced fight, not as a technical reference.

Primary research for this supplement drew on open-source reporting from USNI News, The War Zone/TWZ, Naval News, Army Recognition, GlobalSecurity.org, Naval-Technology.com, SeaForces.org, and the relevant Wikipedia class articles, current as of July 2026. Where sources disagreed (which is common for PLAN systems in particular, since China does not publish official specifications), the most frequently corroborated figures were used.

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US / ALLIED BASE CHART

Kadena AB (Okinawa)

ASR: 3 SAM: 8-8 PD: 4

Ready Aircraft

F-35C	F-35C	F/A-18	F/A-18	F/A-18	F/A-18	EA-18G	P-8A	P-8A
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Flown Aircraft

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Taipei / Zuoying (Taiwan)

ASR: 2 SAM: 6-6 PD: 3

Ready Aircraft

F/A-18	F/A-18	F/A-18	F/A-18	F-35C	F-35C
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Flown Aircraft

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Subic Bay / Clark (Luzon)

ASR: 2 SAM: 4-4 PD: 3

Ready Aircraft

F/A-18	F/A-18	F/A-18	F/A-18	P-8A
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Flown Aircraft

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Gerald R. Ford / Nimitz — Carrier Air Wing

Embarked strike group (typical loadout)

F/A-18E/F	F/A-18E/F	F/A-18E/F	F/A-18E/F	F/A-18E/F	F/A-18E/F	F-35C	F-35C	F-35C	F-35C	EA-18G	EA-18G	E-2D	MQ-4C
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PLA NAVY BASE CHART

Ningbo-Zhoushan (East Sea Fleet HQ)

ASR: 3 SAM: 10-10 PD: 4

Ready Aircraft

J-16	J-16	J-16	J-16	H-6J	H-6J	KJ-500
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Flown Aircraft

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Xiamen (Fujian coast)

ASR: 2 SAM: 6-6 PD: 3

Ready Aircraft

J-16	J-16	J-16	J-16	J-15	J-15
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Flown Aircraft

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Yulin / Sanya (Hainan, South Sea Fleet)

ASR: 2 SAM: 8-4 PD: 3

Ready Aircraft

J-16	J-16	J-16	J-16	Y-9 GX6
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Flown Aircraft

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Fujian / Shandong — Carrier Air Wing

Embarked strike group (typical loadout — Fujian shown; Shandong/Liaoning omit J-35 and KJ-600)

J-15T	J-15T	J-15T	J-15T	J-35	J-35	J-35	J-35	KJ-600	Z-20F	Z-20F
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US Navy — Surface Ships & Submarines

CVN

Gerald R. Ford

USA

Lead ship of the newest US carrier class. Dual Band Radar and an all-electric design give it the fleet's best air-search picture; the ship carries no area-defense missiles of its own and depends entirely on its air wing and escorts for protection.

ASR: 3

SSR: 0

SON: 0

ASW: 4

Speed: 3

Hull: 6

CVN

Nimitz

USA

The proven workhorse carrier, still the backbone of forward-deployed US carrier strike groups even as Ford-class ships enter service. Same self-defense doctrine as Ford: escorts and aircraft do the shooting.

ASR: 3

SSR: 0

SON: 0

ASW: 4

Speed: 3

Hull: 5

CG

Ticonderoga

USA

The Navy's original Aegis cruiser and its largest missile magazine (122 VLS cells). A dwindling, high-value class being retired through the late 2020s — the few that remain are prized area-air-defense escorts, often assigned as strike group flagships.

ASR: 2

SAM: 4-10

PD: 4

SSR: 1

SSM: 2-2

Guns: 2

SON: 4

ASW: 4

Speed: 3

Hull: 3

DDG

Arleigh Burke Flt IIA

USA

The most numerous major surface combatant in the fleet. 96-cell Aegis VLS, SPY-1D radar, two ASW helicopters. The standard escort and multi-mission workhorse of every US carrier and amphibious group.

ASR: 2

SAM: 3-8

PD: 4

SSR: 1

SSM: 2-1

Guns: 2

SON: 4

ASW: 5

Speed: 3

Hull: 2

DDG

Arleigh Burke Flt III

USA

Same hull and 96-cell VLS as Flight IIA, but built around the SPY-6(V)1 AMDR radar — roughly double the detection range and far greater simultaneous-track capacity, enough power growth to fight ballistic missiles, cruise missiles, and small surface contacts at once.

ASR: 3

SAM: 4-10

PD: 5

SSR: 1

SSM: 2-2

Guns: 2

SON: 4

ASW: 5

Speed: 3

Hull: 2

FFG

Constellation

USA

A FREMM-derived multi-mission frigate carrying 16 Naval Strike Missiles and a 32-cell VLS. The program was cut back in late 2025 to just two hulls — in a 2026 scenario, treat this ship as rare and still working up, not a fleet-wide type.

ASR: 2

SAM: 3-4

PD: 3

SSR: 1

SSM: 4-0

Guns: 1

SON: 5

ASW: 4

Speed: 2

Hull: 1

LCS

Independence LCS

USA

A fast, lightly built trimaran fitted with Naval Strike Missiles. Useful as an inexpensive picket or strike-and-scout unit, but it cannot trade blows with a peer combatant and has only point-defense self-protection.

ASR: 1

SAM: 0-0

PD: 2

SSR: 1

SSM: 2-0

Guns: 1

SON: 1

ASW: 1

Speed: 3

Hull: 1

SSN

Los Angeles (688i)

USA

The oldest US fast-attack design still in service, the Improved (688i) boats add a 12-tube vertical launch system for Tomahawk. Being steadily retired as Virginia-class boats replace them hull-for-hull.

ASR: 0

SSR: 1

SSM: 1-4

Torps: 4

SON: 5

ASW: 5

Speed: 3

Hull: 2

US Navy — Surface Ships & Submarines

SSN

Virginia (Blk III/IV)

USA

The Navy's premier multi-mission attack submarine — quieter and better sensed than Los Angeles, with the same 12-tube Tomahawk fit. The fleet's volume SSN.

ASR: 0

SSR: 1

SSM: 1-4

Torps: 4

SON: 6

ASW: 5

Speed: 3

Hull: 2

SSN

Virginia (Blk V, VPM)

USA

An 84-foot hull stretch (the Virginia Payload Module) adds four large-diameter tubes, each holding seven more Tomahawks — over three times the missile capacity of a standard Virginia. Still rare in the fleet in 2026.

ASR: 0

SSR: 1

SSM: 1-10

Torps: 4

SON: 6

ASW: 5

Speed: 3

Hull: 3

SSN

Seawolf

USA

Only three of these boats were built (Seawolf, Connecticut, Jimmy Carter). Eight large-diameter torpedo tubes and the deepest weapons room of any US attack submarine make it the quietest, hardest-hitting SSN in the fleet.

ASR: 0

SSR: 1

SSM: 1-6

Torps: 6

SON: 6

ASW: 5

Speed: 3

Hull: 3

SSGN

Ohio SSGN

USA

Four former ballistic-missile submarines converted to carry up to 154 Tomahawks apiece in modified missile tubes — the single largest missile magazine afloat. The class is aging out; treat it as a scarce, capital-scale strike asset.

ASR: 0

SSR: 1

SSM: 0-16

Torps: 3

SON: 5

ASW: 3

Speed: 3

Hull: 4

LHA

America-class LHA

USA

No well deck — built instead as a de facto light strike carrier ("Lightning Carrier") for up to 20 F-35Bs. Amphibious flagship and, in a pinch, a second flight deck for the fight.

ASR: 2

PD: 3

SSR: 1

SON: 0

ASW: 3

Speed: 2

Hull: 4

LPD

San Antonio LPD

USA

Troop and vehicle lift for a Marine landing force, with a well deck for landing craft and a hangar for one CH-53 or MV-22. Lightly armed — needs an escort.

ASR: 1

PD: 2

SSR: 1

Guns: 1

SON: 0

ASW: 1

Speed: 2

Hull: 3

AO

Fleet Oiler (USN)

USA

Underway replenishment ship — fuel and stores for the fleet. Unarmed; the tyranny-of-distance problem of any Western Pacific campaign runs through ships like this one.

ASR: 0

PD: 0

SSR: 1

SON: 0

ASW: 0

Speed: 2

Hull: 4

US Navy — Aircraft

Patrol

E-2D Advanced Hawkeye

USA

AN/APY-9 radar extends a carrier group's air picture roughly 300 nm — the single most valuable sensor node in the strike group.

ASR: 4

SSR: 4

SON: 0

Radius: 18

Def: 0

Patrol

P-8A Poseidon

USA

Land-based, long-range ASW/surface-search patrol jet operating out of Kadena, Guam, or allied fields. Carries Harpoon and up to 129 sonobuoys.

ASR: 1

SSR: 3

ASM: 0-2

SON: 4

ASW: 5

Radius: 20

Def: 0

Patrol

MQ-4C Triton

USA

Unarmed, 24+ hour-endurance unmanned wide-area maritime surveillance aircraft. Pure sensor platform — cues P-8A and strike aircraft onto targets.

ASR: 0

SSR: 4

SON: 0

Radius: 45

Def: 0

TAC

F/A-18E/F Super Hornet

USA

The carrier air wing's primary strike fighter — AESA radar, up to nine air-to-air missiles, and LRASM/Harpoon for anti-ship work.

ASR: 2

ATA: 3

SSR: 2

ASM: 2-1

Bombs: 2

SON: 0

Radius: 7

Def: 4

TAC

F-35C Lightning II

USA

Stealth carrier fighter with the longest legs of any F-35 variant, a 360° IR sensor, and a full electronic-warfare suite. Hardest US aircraft to detect or defend against.

ASR: 2

ATA: 3

SSR: 1

ASM: 1-2

Bombs: 2

SON: 0

Radius: 10

Def: 5

TAC

EA-18G Growler

USA

Electronic-attack Super Hornet variant carrying ALQ-99 jamming pods and AGM-88 anti-radiation missiles. Special rule: while escorting a strike package, reduce the defending task force's ASR and SSR by 1 (minimum 0) for that attack.

ASR: 2

ATA: 1

SSR: 2

ASM: 1-0

Bombs: 0

SON: 0

Radius: 7

Def: 3

TAC

B-1B Lancer

USA

Land-based heavy bomber carrying up to 24 LRASM across three internal bays — a single flight can mount a saturation anti-ship raid at ranges no carrier air wing can match.

ASR: 0

ATA: 0

SSR: 2

ASM: 0-6

Bombs: 4

SON: 0

Radius: 90

Def: 2

PLA Navy — Surface Ships & Submarines

CV Fujian (Type 003) PRC China's first catapult carrier, commissioned November 2025 and still working up toward full operational capability. Embarks J-35 stealth fighters, J-15T multirole fighters, and the KJ-600 — the PLAN's first fixed-wing carrier AEW aircraft.	ASR: 3 SSR: 0 SON: 0 ASW: 3 Speed: 3 Hull: 6
CV Shandong (Type 002) PRC Ski-jump (STOBAR) carrier, China's first domestically built flattop. No fixed-wing AEW — relies on Z-18 AEW helicopters. Launch-weight limits reduce fuel/weapons load compared to a catapult ship.	ASR: 2 SSR: 0 SON: 0 ASW: 3 Speed: 3 Hull: 5
CV Liaoning (Type 001) PRC The rebuilt ex-Varyag hull — oldest and least capable of China's three active carriers, now largely a training and second-line asset.	ASR: 2 SSR: 0 SON: 0 ASW: 2 Speed: 3 Hull: 4
CG Type 055 (Renhai) PRC 112-cell VLS — the largest missile magazine on any surface combatant in service anywhere. Type 346B AESA radar, a 130mm gun, and full ASW suite make this the PLAN's flagship escort and the most dangerous individual surface unit in the theater.	ASR: 3 SAM: 4-12 PD: 5 SSR: 1 SSM: 0-4 Guns: 3 SON: 5 ASW: 4 Speed: 3 Hull: 3
DDG Type 052D/DL PRC 64-cell VLS, Type 346A radar, YJ-18 anti-ship missiles with a terminal supersonic sprint. The PLAN's most numerous major combatant — its rough equivalent of the Arleigh Burke.	ASR: 2 SAM: 2-8 PD: 4 SSR: 1 SSM: 0-3 Guns: 2 SON: 3 ASW: 3 Speed: 3 Hull: 2
FFG Type 054A PRC PLAN's numerous general-purpose frigate — 32-cell HHQ-16 SAM, 8 YJ-83 anti-ship missiles. Adequate but unspectacular sensors; the class backbone of escort duty since the 2010s.	ASR: 1 SAM: 3-0 PD: 3 SSR: 1 SSM: 2-0 Guns: 1 SON: 3 ASW: 3 Speed: 2 Hull: 1
FFG Type 054B PRC First hull commissioned January 2025. Bigger hull, a new 100mm gun, and improved sensors/hangar (sized for the Z-20F). Still building up in numbers through 2026.	ASR: 2 SAM: 3-0 PD: 3 SSR: 1 SSM: 2-0 Guns: 2 SON: 4 ASW: 4 Speed: 3 Hull: 2
FS Type 056A (Jiangdao) PRC Cheap, mass-produced littoral corvette (~50 hulls built) with only point-defense SAM and no aviation hangar. Numerous but weak against air threats — a good screen/picket unit, not a peer combatant.	ASR: 1 SAM: 1-0 PD: 2 SSR: 1 SSM: 1-0 Guns: 1 SON: 2 ASW: 1 Speed: 2 Hull: 1

PLA Navy — Surface Ships & Submarines

SSN

Type 093B

PRC

The first PLAN attack submarine with a vertical launch system, reportedly carrying YJ-18 and land-attack cruise missiles. Pump-jet propulsion makes it noticeably quieter than earlier Shang boats — the PLAN's most serious current underwater threat to a carrier group.

ASR: 0

SSR: 1

SSM: 0-3

Torps: 5

SON: 5

ASW: 4

Speed: 3

Hull: 3

SSN

Type 093/093A

PRC

Earlier-generation nuclear attack boats, no vertical launch system — anti-ship missiles must be fired from the torpedo tubes. Noisier than 093B but still a capable ambush predator.

ASR: 0

SSR: 1

SSM: 1-0

Torps: 4

SON: 4

ASW: 3

Speed: 3

Hull: 2

SSK

Type 039A/B

PRC

Stirling-cycle air-independent propulsion lets this diesel-electric boat run silent on battery/AIP for days without surfacing. Cheap, quiet, and well suited to ambushing chokepoints like the Bashi Channel — poor sustained transit speed is its main limitation.

ASR: 0

SSR: 1

SSM: 1-0

Torps: 4

SON: 4

ASW: 2

Speed: 2

Hull: 2

LHD

Type 075 (Yushen)

PRC

China's largest amphibious assault ship — helicopter carrier with a floodable well deck for landing craft and armor. Four hulls now in service; the marine landing force flagship.

ASR: 1

PD: 3

SSR: 1

SON: 0

ASW: 2

Speed: 2

Hull: 4

LHD

Type 076 (drone carrier)

PRC

A hybrid amphibious ship with an electromagnetic catapult for launching fixed-wing strike/ISR drones rather than manned fighters. Still in sea trials in 2026 — treat as new and not yet combat-ready.

ASR: 1

PD: 2

SSR: 1

SON: 0

ASW: 1

Speed: 2

Hull: 4

LPD

Type 071 (Yuzhao)

PRC

Troop/vehicle amphibious transport dock with a well deck for air-cushion landing craft. Less aviation capacity than Type 075; needs an escort.

ASR: 1

PD: 2

SSR: 1

Guns: 1

SON: 0

ASW: 1

Speed: 2

Hull: 3

AOE

Type 901 Fuyu AOE

PRC

The only PLAN replenishment ship fast enough to keep pace with a carrier task group indefinitely — five resupply gantries allow simultaneous refueling/rearming of multiple ships underway.

ASR: 0

PD: 1

SSR: 1

SON: 0

ASW: 0

Speed: 3

Hull: 4

AO

Type 903A Oiler

PRC

Standard PLAN fleet oiler, the backbone of routine underway replenishment for surface task groups operating away from a home port.

ASR: 0

PD: 0

SSR: 1

SON: 0

ASW: 0

Speed: 2

Hull: 3

PLA Navy — Aircraft

Patrol

KJ-500/600 AEW

PRC

KJ-500 is the larger, longer-ranged land-based AEW aircraft; KJ-600 is the smaller carrier-based variant now flying from Fujian. Use one card for either, per scenario notes.

ASR: 4

SSR: 4

SON: 0

Radius: 14

Def: 0

Patrol

Y-9 GX6 ASW

PRC

PLAN Aviation's primary land-based ASW/ maritime patrol aircraft — nose radar, tail MAD boom, sonobuoys, and lightweight torpedoes. Shorter-legged than the P-8A.

ASR: 0

SSR: 3

ASM: 0-1

SON: 3

ASW: 4

Radius: 16

Def: 0

TAC

J-15 / J-15T

PRC

PLAN's standard carrier-based multirole fighter. J-15T is the catapult-capable version flying from Fujian; PL-15 gives it a genuine BVR reach.

ASR: 2

ATA: 2

SSR: 2

ASM: 2-1

Bombs: 2

SON: 0

Radius: 6

Def: 3

TAC

J-35

PRC

China's new stealth carrier fighter, now in serial production and flying from Fujian. Still rare fleet-wide in 2026 — treat as scarce and high-value.

ASR: 2

ATA: 3

SSR: 1

ASM: 1-2

Bombs: 1

SON: 0

Radius: 5

Def: 5

TAC

J-16

PRC

Land-based multirole strike fighter also flown by PLAN Aviation for maritime strike escort and stand-off anti-ship missions from mainland/ Hainan airfields.

ASR: 2

ATA: 3

SSR: 2

ASM: 1-2

Bombs: 2

SON: 0

Radius: 8

Def: 4

TAC

H-6J / H-6N

PRC

Land-based maritime strike bomber — up to seven YJ-12 supersonic anti-ship missiles (H-6J), or an air-launched anti-ship ballistic missile on the H-6N. China's primary "carrier-killer" stand-off strike axis.

ASR: 0

ATA: 0

SSR: 2

ASM: 0-5

Bombs: 3

SON: 0

Radius: 60

Def: 1

Generic / Auxiliary Units (both sides)

AUX

Merchant Ship

Represents commercial cargo shipping caught up in a Pacific conflict — unarmed and worth guarding, since sinking one counts heavily in most scenarios.

ASR: 0

SSR: 1

SON: 0

Speed: 2Hull: 4

AUX

Tanker

Bulk fuel carrier; may serve as an underway replenishment ship for either fleet if paired with a task force.

ASR: 0

SSR: 1

SON: 0

Speed: 2Hull: 4

AUX

Generic Amphibious Ship

A stand-in for smaller landing ships and sealift vessels of either navy — lightly defended, always escorted.

ASR: 0

PD: 0

SSR: 1

SON: 0

Speed: 3Hull: 3

Dummy Cards

DUMMY
US NAVY DUMMY
No. 1

Contains no real unit. Reveal to your opponent only when a search successfully detects it, or when switching it between task forces.

DUMMY
US NAVY DUMMY
No. 2

Contains no real unit. Reveal to your opponent only when a search successfully detects it, or when switching it between task forces.

DUMMY
US NAVY DUMMY
No. 3

Contains no real unit. Reveal to your opponent only when a search successfully detects it, or when switching it between task forces.

DUMMY
PLAN DUMMY
No. 1

Contains no real unit. Reveal to your opponent only when a search successfully detects it, or when switching it between task forces.

DUMMY
PLAN DUMMY
No. 2

Contains no real unit. Reveal to your opponent only when a search successfully detects it, or when switching it between task forces.

DUMMY
PLAN DUMMY
No. 3

Contains no real unit. Reveal to your opponent only when a search successfully detects it, or when switching it between task forces.

DUMMY
PLAN DUMMY
No. 4

Contains no real unit. Reveal to your opponent only when a search successfully detects it, or when switching it between task forces.

DUMMY
PLAN DUMMY
No. 5

Contains no real unit. Reveal to your opponent only when a search successfully detects it, or when switching it between task forces.

HARPOON — FIRST ISLAND CHAIN

Roster Sheet

US NAVY

SHIP	HULL	SR-SSM	LR-SSM	TORPS
CVN Gerald R. Ford	Hull □□□□□ □			
CVN Nimitz	Hull □□□□□			
CG Ticonderoga	Hull □□□	SR-SSM □□	LR-SSM □□	
DDG Arleigh Burke Flt IIA	Hull □□	SR-SSM □□	LR-SSM □	
DDG Arleigh Burke Flt III	Hull □□	SR-SSM □□	LR-SSM □□	
FFG Constellation	Hull □	SR-SSM □□□ □		
LCS Independence LCS	Hull □	SR-SSM □□		
SSN Los Angeles (688i)	Hull □□	SR-SSM □	LR-SSM □□□□	Torps □□□□
SSN Virginia (Blk III/IV)	Hull □□	SR-SSM □	LR-SSM □□□□	Torps □□□□
SSN Virginia (Blk V, VPM)	Hull □□□	SR-SSM □	LR-SSM □□□□□□□□□□	Torps □□□□
SSN Seawolf	Hull □□□	SR-SSM □	LR-SSM □□□□□□	Torps □□□□□ □
SSGN Ohio SSGN	Hull □□□□		LR-SSM □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□	Torps □□□
LHA America-class LHA	Hull □□□□			
LPD San Antonio LPD	Hull □□□			
AO Fleet Oiler (USN)	Hull □□□□			
PATROL / CARRIER AIRCRAFT			SERVICEABLE AIRCRAFT	
E-2D Hawkeye			Serviceable □□□□	
P-8A Poseidon No. 1			Serviceable □□□□	
P-8A Poseidon No. 2			Serviceable □□□□	
MQ-4C Triton			Serviceable □□□□	
BASE			DAMAGE	
Kadena AB (Okinawa)			Runway Hits □□□□□□	
Taipei / Zuoying (Taiwan)			Runway Hits □□□□□□	
Subic Bay / Clark (Luzon)			Runway Hits □□□□□□	

PLA NAVY

SHIP	HULL	SR-SSM	LR-SSM	TORPS
CV Fujian (Type 003)	Hull ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐			
CV Shandong (Type 002)	Hull ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐			
CV Liaoning (Type 001)	Hull ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐			
CG Type 055 (Renhai)	Hull ☐ ☐ ☐		LR-SSM ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐	
DDG Type 052D/DL	Hull ☐ ☐		LR-SSM ☐ ☐ ☐	
FFG Type 054A	Hull ☐	SR-SSM ☐ ☐		

FFG Type 054B	Hull ☐ ☐	SR-SSM ☐ ☐	
FS Type 056A (Jiangdao)	Hull ☐	SR-SSM ☐	
SSN Type 093B	Hull ☐ ☐ ☐		LR-SSM ☐ ☐ ☐ Torps ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
SSN Type 093/093A	Hull ☐ ☐	SR-SSM ☐	Torps ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
SSK Type 039A/B	Hull ☐ ☐	SR-SSM ☐	Torps ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
LHD Type 075 (Yushen)	Hull ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐		
LHD Type 076 (drone carrier)	Hull ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐		
LPD Type 071 (Yuzhao)	Hull ☐ ☐ ☐		
AOE Type 901 Fuyu AOE	Hull ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐		
AO Type 903A Oiler	Hull ☐ ☐ ☐		
PATROL / CARRIER AIRCRAFT		SERVICEABLE AIRCRAFT	
KJ-500/600 AEW		Serviceable ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐	
Y-9 GX6 ASW No. 1		Serviceable ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐	
Y-9 GX6 ASW No. 2		Serviceable ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐	
BASE		DAMAGE	
Ningbo-Zhoushan		Runway Hits ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐	
Xiamen		Runway Hits ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐	
Yulin / Sanya (Hainan)		Runway Hits ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐	

GENERIC / AUXILIARY (either side)

SHIP	HULL
Merchant Ship	Hull ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Tanker	Hull ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Generic Amphibious Ship	Hull ☐ ☐ ☐

Photocopy this sheet freely for personal play, exactly as with the original Harpoon Captain's Edition roster pad.

TURN RECORD (21-turn campaign scale)

T1 AM	T2 PM	T3 AM	T4 PM	T5 AM	T6 PM	T7 AM	T8 PM	T9 AM	T10 PM	T11 AM	T12 PM	T13 AM	T14 PM	T15 AM	T16 PM	T17 AM	T18 PM	T19 AM	T20 PM	T21 AM
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Scenarios

These scenarios use the same rules, dice tables, and turn sequence as *Harpoon Captain's Edition* — only the map, the units, and the order of battle have changed. Play them in order the first time through; each one introduces a new part of the rules, exactly as scenarios 1-15 do in the original *Captain's Rules* booklet. Hex references (e.g. hex 0804) are to the *First Island Chain* map.

1 Contact off the Bashi Channel

An **Arleigh Burke Flt IIA** is escorting a merchant ship toward Subic Bay when it encounters a PLAN **Type 054A** frigate and a **Type 071** LPD it is screening.

Setup: Place the PLAN force three hexes east of Taiwan (hex 1010). Place the US force three hexes southwest of it (hex 0713). This starts the two forces three hexes apart.

Victory: Whichever side inflicts the most damage on the other's merchant/amphibious ship wins.

2 Flagship Duel

A **Type 055 Renhai** must attack a strongly defended US formation built around an **Ivan Rogov**-style amphibious analog — for this scenario, substitute a **San Antonio LPD** screened by two **Arleigh Burke Flt IIA** destroyers and one **Ticonderoga**.

Setup: Place the PLAN force three hexes due west of Taiwan (hex 0510). Place the US force three hexes southeast of it (hex 1213).

Victory: Whichever side inflicts the most hull hits on the other's warships wins.

3 Close Aboard

Three PLAN **Type 056A** corvettes are scouting the Bashi Channel when they run into a US **Arleigh Burke Flt IIA** and an escorting **Constellation**-class frigate. Both sides close for a gun action.

Setup: Place the PLAN task force three hexes east of Taiwan (hex 1010). Place the US task force three hexes southeast of it (hex 1313).

Victory: Whichever side inflicts the most hull hits with gunfire wins.

4 Picket Line

A US task force must move from Subic Bay to Taipei/Zuoying. Using (or not using) radar, it must find any enemy ships and avoid them if possible — or fight its way past while protecting a merchant ship.

Forces: US: two merchant ships, one **Arleigh Burke Flt IIA**, two **Constellation**-class frigates. PLAN: two **Type 054A** frigates and one **Type 052D/DL** destroyer.

Setup: Place the US task force in Subic Bay. Place the PLAN task force anywhere on the map, but not within four hexes of either Subic Bay or Taipei/Zuoying.

Victory: The US player wins if he sinks the PLAN amphibious/escort force. Otherwise, the PLAN player wins.

5 Ghost Fleet

A replay of Scenario 4, but with all of the dummy cards for both sides also in play. A useful reminder that in this theater, the PLAN's dense coastal sensor network and home-field ISR give *it* the larger dummy allotment (5 dummies to the US Navy's 3) — the reverse of the original GIUK-gap game, where NATO held that edge.

6 Wolves of the Bashi Channel

A PLAN wolf pack must patrol the Bashi Channel between Taiwan and Luzon. A US carrier task force is expected to pass through in the next few days, but first a US antisubmarine hunter-killer formation will try to clear the strait.

Forces: US: one **Arleigh Burke Flt III**, one **Los Angeles**-class SSN, two **Constellation**-class frigates. PLAN: two **Type 039A/B (Yuan)** SSKs and one **Type 093B** SSN.

Setup: Place all PLAN forces on a line between hex 0812 and hex 1212. They must remain within two hexes of that line. The US force (or forces) enters from the east map edge.

Victory: The game lasts seven turns. The PLAN player's mission is to survive, evading or destroying the attackers, keeping at least two boats alive. Every two US ships sunk offsets the loss of one PLAN sub. Failing this, the US player wins.

7 Lifeline to Taiwan

A resupply convoy must reach Taipei/Zuoying with badly needed fuel and munitions. PLAN submarines attempt to prevent it.

Forces: US: two **Constellation**-class frigates, one **Arleigh Burke Flt IIA**, three merchant ships, one tanker. PLAN: two **Type 039A/B** SSKs and one **Type 093B** SSN.

Setup: All US forces begin within two hexes of hex 0910. PLAN forces may be placed anywhere except in Taipei/Zuoying or within two hexes of hex 0910.

Victory: The game lasts 10 turns. The US player wins if three or more merchant ships survive and reach Taipei/Zuoying. Each PLAN sub sunk offsets the loss of one merchant ship. Failing this, the PLAN player wins.

8 Hunt the Dragon

A barrier of US submarines and P-8As in the Bashi Channel must block the passage of a PLAN carrier battle group built around the **Fujian**.

Forces: PLAN forces consist of one **Fujian**-class carrier, one **Type 055** cruiser, one **Type 052D/DL** destroyer, and one **Type 054B** frigate. US forces consist of two **Virginia**-class SSNs and two **Los Angeles**-class SSNs.

Setup: Place all PLAN task forces on a line from hex 0812 to hex 1212. Once the game starts, they must remain within two hexes of their starting line. US forces enter from the east map edge.

Victory: The game lasts seven turns. The US player must sink the *Fujian* to win. PLAN wins by getting the carrier, still capable of launching aircraft, off the west board edge.

9 Patroller

A group of PLAN submarines have left Xiamen and are moving toward the open Philippine Sea. US patrol aircraft must hunt them down and sink them.

Forces: PLAN has three **Type 039A/B** SSKs and one **Type 093B** SSN. US has one **P-8A Poseidon** and one **Los Angeles**-class SSN.

Setup: PLAN places its task forces within 10 hexes of Xiamen. US places its task force at least 15 hexes from Xiamen. The P-8A is based at Kadena.

Victory: The game lasts 15 turns. PLAN wins if it exits three or more submarines off the east edge of the map. Failing this, the US player wins.

10 First Light Over the East China Sea

A US carrier battle group must enter the East China Sea, where it will conduct a series of air strikes on Ningbo-Zhoushan.

Forces: US has one **Gerald R. Ford**-class carrier, one **Ticonderoga**-class cruiser, one **Arleigh Burke Flt III**, and two **Constellation**-class frigates. The carrier's air wing is at full strength. PLAN has two flights of **J-16**, one flight of **H-6J**, and two **Type 093B** SSNs, all based at or operating from Ningbo-Zhoushan.

Setup: The US player starts all ships at Kadena. PLAN starts all aircraft at Ningbo-Zhoushan and all task forces within 10 hexes of it.

Victory: The game lasts 12 turns. The US player must get the carrier, still capable of launching aircraft, from Kadena to within two hexes of hex 0206. Failing this, the PLAN player wins.

Advanced Scenarios: The Mission System

Exactly as in the *Captain's Briefing*, each side secretly draws a mission and purchases forces against a mission budget of **asset points**. Each ship costs asset points equal to its Hull value, with two exceptions carried over unchanged from the original game:

Cost class	Asset point cost	Applies to
High-cost	2 × Hull value	All carriers (Ford, Nimitz, Fujian, Shandong), Ticonderoga, Arleigh Burke Flt III, Virginia Blk V, Seawolf, Ohio SSGN, America-class LHA — and Type 055, Type 075, Type 076
Low-cost	Hull value – 1	LCS Independence, Type 039A/B (Yuan), Type 056A (Jiangdao)
Standard	= Hull value	Everything else

Aircraft carriers are purchased without their air wing; the air group counters shown on the base chart must be purchased separately, exactly as in the original rules. Bases: Kadena and Ningbo-Zhoushan are always home bases for their respective sides and can never be captured. Taipei/Zuoying and Subic Bay may be treated as capturable forward bases in scenarios that call for it, using the same capture rules as Keflavik/Bödo in the original *Captain's Briefing* (p.2–3) — substitute Xiamen and Yulin/Sanya as the PLAN's equivalent vulnerable forward bases if you want a fully symmetrical campaign.

US Navy Mission Descriptions

Mission 1 — Background: PLAN's opening move was a swift blockade of the Bashi Channel and a missile barrage on Taipei/Zuoying. **Objective:** Prevent PLAN forces from closing the Strait for six consecutive turns. **Forces:** 15 points.

Mission 2 — Background: Fighting near Taiwan has been even so far, but a renewed PLAN push threatens Subic Bay's approaches. **Objective:** Destroy at least six enemy asset points, and destroy at least two more asset points of PLAN forces than you lose yourself. Failing this, prevent PLAN from achieving its objective. **Forces:** 10 points.

Mission 3 — Background: As a prelude to a wider counteroffensive, you must strike a blow against PLAN air power ashore. **Objective:** Destroy the runway at either Xiamen or Yulin/Sanya. Failing this, prevent PLAN from achieving its objective. **Forces:** 25 points.

Mission 4 — Background: PLAN has seized a foothold on a contested reef feature in the South China Sea. **Objective:** Land a Marine landing force and recapture the feature; one amphibious ship must spend two full turns in the target hex. **Forces:** 45 points.

Mission 5 — Background: A renewed PLAN push threatens Taipei/Zuoying directly. **Objective:** Escort a resupply convoy to Taipei/Zuoying. At least one merchant ship or tanker must spend two full turns in the Taipei/Zuoying hex. **Forces:** 20 points.

Mission 6 — Background: A major carrier strike group action is imminent in the East China Sea. **Objective:** Destroy at least six enemy asset points and at least two more than you lose. In addition, prevent PLAN from achieving its objective. **Forces:** 25 points.

Mission 7 — Background: Sea lane interdiction in the Philippine Sea requires a substantial naval presence astride the approaches. **Objective:** Exit at least eight asset points of naval combatants off the west edge of the map (amphibs, tankers, and merchants do not count). **Forces:** 20 points.

Mission 8 — Background: Morale at home is sagging; a visible victory is needed. **Objective:** Destroy the runway at Ningbo-Zhoushan, or sink the *Fujian* or a *Type 055*. **Forces:** 30 points.

Mission 9 — Background: Success elsewhere has freed up considerable assets for a knockout blow in the First Island Chain. **Objective:** Destroy 90% of PLAN assets in the game. Alternatively, destroy over half of PLAN's assets and destroy the runway at Ningbo-Zhoushan. **Forces:** 50 points.

PLA Navy Mission Descriptions

Mission 1 — Background: Efforts to force the Bashi Channel have been frustrated by US and allied air power based on Taiwan. **Objective:** Capture or neutralize Taipei/Zuoying airfield. Failing this, destroy at least 10 US asset points (or half of the US total, whichever is smaller) and prevent the US player from achieving its objective. **Forces:** 45 points.

Mission 2 — Background: Amphibious groups aiming for a contested reef have been checked by US and allied naval forces. **Objective:** Land troops on the target feature and hold it; at least one amphibious ship must spend two full turns in the objective hex. **Forces:** 25 points.

Mission 3 — Background: Resources are tied down covering the Taiwan Strait, leaving little for other fronts. **Objective:** Prevent the US player from achieving their objective. **Forces:** 15 points.

Mission 4 — Background: The naval war has gone badly, and most of the East Sea Fleet's striking power has been lost. **Objective:** Destroy at least six enemy asset points, and destroy at least two more asset points of US forces than you lose yourself. Failing this, prevent the US player from achieving its objective. **Forces:** 10 points.

Mission 5 — Background: The South Sea Fleet has broken out through the Bashi Channel and now needs fuel and munitions. **Objective:** Exit either one merchant ship or one fleet oiler off the west edge of the map. **Forces:** 20 points.

Mission 6 — Background: A major fleet effort will soon be launched from Ningbo-Zhoushan. **Objective:** Destroy at least six enemy asset points worth of forces, and destroy at least two more than you lose. Prevent the US player from achieving its objective. **Forces:** 25 points.

Mission 7 — Background: Various commitments elsewhere make it impossible to conduct extensive combat operations right now. **Objective:** Have one surface ship or submarine within three hexes of Ningbo-Zhoushan at the end of the game. **Forces:** 10 points.

Mission 8 — Background: Morale is sagging; an important and visible victory is required. **Objective:** Destroy the runway at Kadena, or sink the *Gerald R. Ford* or a *Ticonderoga*. **Forces:** 30 points.

Mission 9 — Background: Success elsewhere has freed considerable assets for a knockout blow in the theater. **Objective:** Destroy 90% of US assets in the game. Alternatively, destroy over half of US assets and destroy the runway at Kadena. **Forces:** 50 points.

Victory in any advanced scenario: the game lasts 21 turns (7 days) or until one player concedes, whichever comes first. Both players then reveal missions and compare objectives, exactly as described on p.7 of the original Captain's Briefing.